

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 181

By Yager

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of R.W. Groom III of Nashville.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the untimely passing of R.W. Groom III; and

WHEREAS, R.W. Groom was a creative soul with a gentle, humble spirit who did his utmost to improve the well-being of all who were blessed to know him; and

WHEREAS, the only child of R.W. Groom, Jr., and Bernice Vance Groom, Mr. Groom was born in Lebanon and moved with his family at the age of nine to El Paso, Texas, where his father was stationed at Fort Bliss as a member of the U.S. Army; and

WHEREAS, the Groom family later moved to Murfreesboro, and R.W. Groom attended Mitchell Nielson Elementary School, where his mother was a teacher; he went on to attend Murfreesboro Central High School, where he was a member of the tennis team, played trombone in the band, joined the Sigma Chi Omega fraternity, and was a pitcher in recreation league baseball; and

WHEREAS, R.W. Groom earned his bachelor's degree in English from the University of Tennessee at Martin, where he played tennis, partook in theatrical play productions, and sang and played guitar around town; he was inspired by his high school English teachers to become an English teacher himself and ultimately went on to earn his Master of English degree and Education Specialist degree in Administration from Middle Tennessee State University; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Groom taught English for grades 7-12 for forty years at various schools, including Fayetteville Junior High School, Apollo Middle School, Hillsboro High School, Cohn Learning Center, and Antioch High School, where he met the love of his life, Pam, who was also a teacher there; and

WHEREAS, during his tenure in education, he coached tennis, served as yearbook supervisor, started the Hillsboro recycling site, led students on various trips, and worked for Homework Hotline; he also coached his son's basketball, soccer, and baseball teams and his daughter's softball and basketball teams; and

WHEREAS, a man of faith, he accepted Christ as his savior at the age of ten at First Baptist Church in Murfreesboro, where he was active in youth group and choir; he and his wife were members of Woodmont Christian Church, where he served as deacon on two occasions, chaired Room in the Inn, chaired Outreach Committee, worked with Habitat for Humanity, taught Sunday School, and chaperoned mission trips; and

WHEREAS, he was also deeply devoted to his family and always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Groom is survived by his wife of thirty-one years, Pamela Jones Groom; son, Taylor Groom; daughter, Anna Kathryn Groom; nieces, Juliet Jones, Abigail Jones, and Mackenzie Burgess; nephew, Austin Burgess; sisters-in-law, Kim Burgess and Mandy Jones; brother-in-law, Rod Burgess; mother-in-law, Mary Jane Jones; and many beloved cousins and extended family members; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, he was preceded in death by his brother-in-law Brad Jones, his mother-in-law Betty Jones, his father-in-law Gary Jones, and his beloved aunts and uncles on the Vance/Groom side; and

WHEREAS, throughout his many worthy endeavors, R.W. Groom distinguished himself as a beacon of kindness and wisdom; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should pay tribute to the bountiful life of this exceptional Tennessean; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH
GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF

REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of R.W. Groom III, reflecting fondly upon his ability to live the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our sympathy and condolences to the family and friends of Mr. Groom.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.